



Watch 24/7

TRENDING

OPD

Diddy

Hilton interview



Playoff baseball



Fleet Week



Wo...

SAN FRANCISCO

San Francisco to keep Flock cameras with new limits on data access

City leaders said they want to strike a balance between effective law enforcement and protecting civil liberties.

By **NBC Bay Area staff** • Published September 29, 2026 • Updated on September 29, 2026 at 3:20 pm

San Francisco leaders on Tuesday rolled out new rules for the police department when it comes to using data from the city's network of license plate reading cameras. Sergio Quintana reports.

San Francisco will keep its Flock license plate cameras but put new limits on who can access the data they record, officials announced Tuesday.

City leaders said they want to strike a balance between effective law enforcement and protecting civil liberties.

Watch NBC Bay Area News free wherever you are

WATCH HERE

Under the new policy, officers will need approval from leadership and a connection to an active criminal investigation to search data tied to the city's network of automated license plate readers (ALPR).

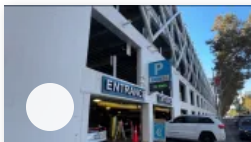
The data will also be removed from Flock's platform after 30 days. San Francisco police will keep their own copy for up to a year.

The city's Department of Police Accountability will also conduct regular audits on how the department is handling its ALPR data.

The city's Human Rights Commission recently completed its own independent audit, making a few recommendations on better practices.

The police department has also conducted its own internal audits and announced some of its key findings earlier this year that led to tightened controls on outside agencies that access the city's ALPR data.

Local



6 HOURS AGO

San Jose City Council approves municipal garage rate hikes, puts street parking meter increases on hold



8 HOURS AGO

HUD's \$4 billion grant program aims to reduce homelessness, but will it do the opposite?

District Attorney Brooke Jenkins said she asked state Assemblymember Matt Haney to work on state legislation that would make it a crime for a police officer or anyone else to access ALPR data for personal or inappropriate reasons.

"I became concerned not only with the fact that people were being put in harm's way by the misuse and abuse of access to this data, but also that if that continued to happen we would compromise our ability here in San Francisco to be able to continue to use the technology," Jenkins said.

Jenkins and Haney are considering if proposed state legal sanctions would be misdemeanor and/or potentially felony charges.

This article tagged under:

SAN FRANCISCO

Weather Forecast

SAN JOSE, CA

57°

Clear
0% Precip

TONIGHT

59°

TOMORROW

88°

SUBMIT TIPS FOR INVESTIGATIONS

NEWSLETTERS

ABOUT US

CONNECT WITH US

OUR NEWS STANDARDS

NBC SPORTS BAY AREA

XFINITY: INTERNET, TV, STREAMING, MORE

[KNTV Public Inspection File](#)

[KNTV Accessibility](#)

[KNTV Employment Information](#)

[Send Feedback](#)

[FCC Applications](#)

[Terms of Service](#)

[Privacy Policy](#)

[Your Privacy Choices](#)

[Advertise with us](#)

[CA Notice](#)

[Ad Choices](#)